

Expertise Boundary Clinic Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 30-40 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	expertise-boundary-clinic

Big idea: Expertise is powerful evidence within boundaries, but those boundaries must be identified.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students decide when expert authority should be trusted, challenged, or limited across different knowledge claims.

Student Prompt

Inspect Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Expert: climate scientist; claims about atmospheric data, energy policy, election strategy, and personal lifestyle choices. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Expert: novelist; claims about narrative technique, historical fact, psychology, and moral value. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Expertise Boundary Clinic Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Expert: novelist; claims about narrative technique, historical fact, psychology, and moral value. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Expertise is powerful evidence within boundaries, but those boundaries must be identified.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
6	When is expert authority a good reason to believe?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Cross-AOK.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how expertise is powerful evidence within boundaries, but those boundaries must be identified.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: When is expert authority a good reason to believe?

Setup Checklist

- Create expert cards that include real strengths and clear limits.
- Include claims that are inside, adjacent to, and outside the expert's domain.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Expert: climate scientist; claims about atmospheric data, energy policy, election strategy, and personal lifestyle choices.
- Expert: novelist; claims about narrative technique, historical fact, psychology, and moral value.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/expertise-boundary-clinic/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/expertise-boundary-clinic/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/expertise-boundary-clinic/visual-prompt.svg>
- Boundary checklist: domain, evidence, consensus, conflict of interest, uncertainty.
- Claim sorting mat: inside expertise, adjacent, outside, needs more evidence.

Run Sequence

1. Give groups an expert profile and several claims the expert might make.
2. Students decide which claims fall inside, near, or outside the expert's domain.
3. Groups identify what extra evidence would be needed for each claim.
4. Compare cases where expertise should carry more or less weight.
5. Debrief responsible trust in knowledge communities.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: When is expert authority a good reason to believe?
- How can knowers respect expertise without surrendering judgement?
- What counts as overreach beyond a domain of knowledge?

Teacher Quick Script

- Respecting expertise includes knowing its boundaries.
- What would make this expert's claim stronger or weaker evidence?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...